



BEKWAI YOUTH MOVEMENT

VOLUNTEERING FOR CHANGE

BYM YOUTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY

OFFICIAL GOVERNANCE & OPERATIONS DOCUMENT

Sefwi Bekwai | Western North Region | Ghana

Aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) 2030

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PREAMBLE

We, the founding leadership of the Bekwai Youth Movement (BYM), in recognition of the vast untapped potential of young people across Sefwi Bekwai and its 31 surrounding sub-communities, and in full alignment with the United Nations 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, do hereby establish the BYM Youth General Assembly as the supreme youth governance body of the Bekwai Youth Movement.

This document constitutes the official governance framework, organisational structure, leadership architecture, traditional authority integration, representation policy, database management system, SDG alignment framework, and strategic launch roadmap of the BYM Youth General Assembly. It shall be binding upon all members, representatives, officers, and volunteers of the Assembly from the date of its ratification.

BYM Core Mission

To harness the potential of all young people in Sefwi Bekwai and its 31 surrounding sub-communities through structured governance, community intelligence, volunteerism, and sustained leadership development, in alignment with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

SDG Alignment

- ☐ SDG 4 (Quality Education)
- ☐ SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities)
- ☐ SDG 16 (Peace, Justice & Strong Institutions)
- ☐ SDG 17 (Partnerships for the Goals)



SECTION 1: BYM UNITS & ORGANISATIONAL DIVISIONS

The BYM Youth General Assembly is organised into seven (7) distinct Units. Each Unit has a defined mandate, a dedicated portfolio officer, and a direct SDG alignment. Together, these Units constitute the operational engine of the Assembly.

No	Unit Name	Mandate & Function	Portfolio Officer	SDG Links
1	Governance & Civic Affairs Unit	Oversees Youth Parliament, civic education, legislative processes, and constitutional compliance. Ensures democratic governance within the Assembly.	Secretary-General	SDG 16, 17
2	Education & Youth Development Unit	Manages school partnerships, literacy support, mentorship, skills training, and the Youth Development Academy.	Secretary for Education	SDG 4, 8
3	Health & Social Welfare Unit	Leads community health campaigns, mental health awareness, child protection, and social welfare interventions.	Secretary for Health & Welfare	SDG 3, 5
4	Economic Empowerment & Employment Unit	Coordinates youth entrepreneurship, apprenticeship linkages, microfinance access, and job-readiness programmes.	Secretary for Economic Affairs	SDG 1, 8, 10
5	Environment, Sanitation & Climate Unit	Manages sanitation campaigns, tree planting, environmental education, and climate adaptation projects.	Secretary for Environment	SDG 6, 11, 13, 15
6	Community Intelligence & Data Unit	Operates the Community Intelligence Network (CIN), monthly reporting, database management, and impact measurement.	Director of Intelligence	SDG 16, 17
7	Communications, Media & Partnerships Unit	Manages public communications, website, social media, media relations, diaspora outreach, and institutional partnerships.	Secretary for Communications	SDG 17



SECTION 2: LEADERSHIP STRUCTURE FOR YGA

The BYM Youth General Assembly adopts a governance model modelled on the United Kingdom Cabinet System, adapted to the Ghanaian community governance context. This system provides clear Ministerial accountability, a Cabinet of Secretaries of State with portfolio responsibilities, and a Parliament with Speaker-led proceedings, mirroring both Westminster governance standards and Ghana's constitutional tradition.

2.1 The Supreme Authority, BYM Founding Leadership

Role of BYM Founding Leadership

The BYM Founding Leadership is the supreme, non-elected governing authority above all Assembly structures. It ratifies the Constitution, approves senior Cabinet appointments, holds final authority on strategic decisions, and may dissolve and reconstitute the Assembly in cases of fundamental governance failure.

It is non-partisan and non-political.

2.2 The Executive: The Cabinet of the General Assembly

Modelled on the United Kingdom Cabinet of Ministers, the BYM Cabinet is headed by the President (equivalent to the Prime Minister) and comprises Secretaries of State each holding a defined portfolio. The Cabinet meets monthly and is collectively accountable to the General Assembly.

No	Cabinet Position (UK Equivalent)	Portfolio & Responsibilities	Requirements	SDG
1	Director General [DG] of the Youth General Assembly	Supreme head of the Assembly; chairs Cabinet and General Assembly sittings; represents BYM externally; signs all official documents; sets strategic direction; appoints Cabinet Secretaries subject to BYM approval.	Ages 22 - 35; min. 2 yrs BYM membership; demonstrated leadership; community resident min. 2 years.	SDG 16, 17
2	1st Deputy Director General [DGG]	Deputises the DG; chairs Cabinet in DG's absence; oversees cross-portfolio coordination; manages civil Secretaries' performance and accountability.	Ages 20 - 33; min. 1 yr BYM; strong organisational capacity; resident min. 2 yrs.	SDG 16
3	2nd Deputy Director General [DGG]	Oversees Community Intelligence Network and data operations; manages CIN Director; ensures monthly reports are compiled and submitted on time.	Ages 20 - 33; data literacy preferred; min. 1 yr BYM; resident min. 2 yrs.	SDG 17
4	Secretary-General (Civic Secretary / Chief of Staff)	Chief administrative officer of the Assembly; custodian of all official documents and	Ages 20 - 35; strong writing and admin skills; min. 1 yr BYM.	SDG 16



No	Cabinet Position (UK Equivalent)	Portfolio & Responsibilities	Requirements	SDG
		records; records all minutes; manages official correspondence; registers new members.		
5	Deputy Secretary-General(Deputy Civic/Town Secretary)	Assists the Secretary-General; manages digital communications; maintains website and social media; coordinates digital records.	Ages 18 - 33; digital literacy required; min. 6 months BYM.	SDG 17
6	Chief financial officer (Chancellor of the Exchequer)	CFO manages all Assembly funds; prepares and presents quarterly financial reports; countersigns all transactions above GHS 500; maintains financial records in the BYM database.	Ages 20 - 40; financial literacy essential; trustworthy track record; min. 1 yr BYM.	SDG 17
7	Deputy Financial Secretary to the Treasury board	Assists the CFO; manages petty cash and project-level expenditure; tracks and reconciles community project budgets.	Ages 18 - 35; basic financial literacy; min. 6 months BYM.	SDG 17
8	Secretary for Education & Youth(Secretary of State for Education)	Leads the Education & Youth Development Unit; oversees Youth Parliament programme; manages school partnerships; runs the Youth Development Academy.	Ages 20 - 38; teaching or mentoring background preferred; passionate about civic education.	SDG 4, 8
9	Secretary for Health & Welfare(Secretary of Bekwai for Health)	Leads the Health & Social Welfare Unit; coordinates health campaigns; manages child protection protocols; oversees social welfare volunteer teams.	Ages 22- 40; health or social work background preferred.	SDG 3, 5
10	Secretary for Economic Affairs(Civic Secretary for Work, Entrepreneurship, Training & Youth Employment)	Leads the Economic Empowerment & Employment Unit; coordinates apprenticeship, microfinance, and entrepreneurship programmes across all 32 communities.	Ages 22 - 40; business or economics background preferred.	SDG 1, 8, 10
11	Secretary for Environment(Civic Secretary for Environment)	Leads the Environment, Sanitation & Climate Unit; manages Volunteer Action Teams for sanitation, tree-planting, and climate education projects.	Ages 18 - 38; passion for environment and public health.	SDG 6, 11, 13, 15
12	Secretary for Communications(Civic Secretary for Digital, Culture & Media)	Leads the Communications Unit; manages all public-facing communications, social media, newsletters, press	Ages 18 - 35; journalism, media, or comms background preferred.	SDG 17



No	Cabinet Position (UK Equivalent)	Portfolio & Responsibilities	Requirements	SDG
		releases, and the BYM website.		
13	Home Secretary (Civic Secretary for the Interior)	Manages internal Assembly security, conflict resolution, member conduct, and the enforcement of the Code of Conduct. Investigates grievances and misconduct reports.	Ages 22 - 40; strong integrity; respected by peers; min. 2 yrs BYM.	SDG 16
14	Secretary for Regional Affairs & Partnerships (Regional Secretary)	Manages all external partnerships, NGOs, connecting other regions across Ghana, government bodies, diaspora, international organisations. Leads partnership negotiations and MOUs.	Ages 22 - 40; communication and networking skills; international exposure advantageous.	SDG 17
15	Secretary for Women & Gender Equality (Director for Women & Equalities)	Ensures minimum 40% female representation across all Assembly arms; leads women-focused development programmes; reports gender equality metrics quarterly.	Female preferred; ages 18 - 40; advocacy experience preferred.	SDG 5, 10
16	Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs (Leader of the House)	Manages the relationship between the Civic Cabinet (CC) and the Youth Parliament; schedules Parliamentary sessions; conveys CC decisions to Parliament; facilitates Parliamentary procedure.	Ages 20 - 38; strong communication; min. 1 yr BYM.	SDG 16
17	Civic Organiser (Chief Whip)	Coordinates all BYM events, sittings, and community outreach; manages logistics; ensures all members attend Assembly meetings; maintains attendance records.	Ages 20 - 35; high energy; strong interpersonal skills; min. 1 yr BYM.	SDG 11, 17
18	Deputy Organiser (Deputy Chief Whip)	Assists the Organiser; manages sub-community event coordination.	Ages 18 - 33; community connections; min. 6 months BYM.	SDG 17
19	Inter-Community Liaison [ICL] Officer (Civil Lead)	Manages relations with Muslim, Zongo, and minority communities; ensures every sub-group is represented and heard within the Assembly.	Ages 20 - 40; trusted across community groups; strong interpersonal skills.	SDG 10, 16



2.3 The Legislative Arm - Bekwai Youth Parliament (BYP)

The Bekwai Youth Parliament mirrors the Parliament of Ghana. It is presided over by a Speaker and serves as the legislative and deliberative voice of youth aged 10 -17 in Bekwai

No	Parliament Office	Role & Function	Requirements	SDG
1	Speaker of the Youth Parliament	Presides over all Parliament sittings; maintains order; certifies Youth Recommendations to the CC; represents Parliament at formal Assembly events.	Ages 15 -17; elected by Parliament members; strong public speaking.	SDG 16
2	Deputy Speaker	Deputises the Speaker; assists in managing sittings; oversees procedural compliance.	Ages 15 - 17; elected by Parliament members.	SDG 16
3	Parliament Majority Leader(Civic Frontbench Lead)	Leads the majority caucus; schedules debates; coordinates with the Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs.	Ages 15 - 17; elected.	SDG 16
4	Parliament Minority / Opposition Leader(Shadow Leader of the House)	Leads the minority caucus; ensures balanced debate; presents alternative perspectives and shadow recommendations.	Ages 14 - 17; elected.	SDG 16
5	Parliament Clerk	Records all Parliament minutes; manages Parliament documentation; files Youth Recommendations.	Ages 14 -17; good writing skills.	SDG 16, 17
6	Community Parliament Members (x32)	One per community; attends all sittings; represents youth of their community; submits issues for debate; reports back to community; serves 2-year terms.	Ages 10 - 17; nominated by school or community; resident min. 6 months; parental consent required.	SDG 4, 16

2.4 Community Intelligence Network (CIN) Leadership

No	Position	Responsibilities	Requirements	SDG
1	Director of Community Intelligence	Oversees all 32 CIN Officers; designs data collection tools; compiles Monthly Community Reports; manages the BYM database; reports to 2nd VP.	Ages 22 - 40; data/research background; min. 1 yr BYM.	SDG 16, 17
2	Deputy Director of Intelligence	Assists Director; conducts field training for CIN Officers; verifies monthly data submissions; manages digital reporting tools.	Ages 20 - 35; digital literacy required.	SDG 16
3	Data Quality Officer	Audits monthly submissions for accuracy and completeness; flags inconsistencies; maintains data integrity standards across the database.	Ages 20 - 38; analytical skills; basic statistics advantageous.	SDG 16



No	Position	Responsibilities	Requirements	SDG
4	Community Intelligence Officers (x32)	One per community; collects monthly data; submits Community Intelligence Reports using standardized forms; flags urgent issues immediately to the Director.	Ages 18+; literate; trusted in community; willing to commit to monthly reporting.	SDG 16, 11



SECTION 3: TRADITIONAL AUTHORITY & COMMUNITY LEADERS FRAMEWORK

The BYM Youth General Assembly recognises that traditional authority is the bedrock of community **trust** in Sefwi Bekwai and its surrounding communities. No youth governance system can succeed without the blessing, involvement, and active partnership of traditional and community leaders. This section defines their formal role within the BYM structure.

3.1 The BYM Traditional Advisory Council (TAC)

Purpose of the Traditional Advisory Council

The Traditional Advisory Council (TAC) is the highest honorary body within the BYM Youth General Assembly structure. It does not hold executive power but commands moral authority, community trust, and cultural legitimacy. The TAC serves as the guardian of BYM's values, the protector of its non-political status, and the bridge between the Assembly and the traditional governance system.

TAC Membership

- ☐ The Paramount Chief of Sefwi Bekwai or their designated representative, serving as Patron of the Assembly
- ☐ The Sub-Chiefs of each of the 31 surrounding sub-communities, each serving as Community Patron for their area
- ☐ The Queenmother of Sefwi Bekwai or representative, serving as Women's Patron
- ☐ The Municipal Chief Executive (MCE) or their representative, serving as Government Liaison Patron - Optional
- ☐ The Head of the Bibiani-Anhwiaso-Bekwai Municipal Assembly or representative, as Institutional Patron

3.2 How Chiefs and Community Authorities Are Involved

Stage / Function	How Traditional Authority is Involved	Responsible BYM Officer
Formal Blessing & Launch	Before any community-level BYM activity begins, the BYM President pays a formal courtesy call on the Paramount Chief and relevant sub-chiefs to present the Assembly, seek their blessing, and receive their endorsement. A formal letter of introduction is presented.	DGt + Secretary-General
Community Sensitisation	Sub-chiefs and family heads are formally briefed by the BYM Civic Organiser before any sensitisation activity in their community. Their permission is sought and their endorsement publicised.	Organiser + relevant Secretary
Nomination Legitimacy	All community representative nominations require a letter of endorsement or verbal endorsement from the community's sub-chief, unit committee member, or recognised elder. No nomination is valid without this.	Secretary-General + Director of Intelligence



Stage / Function	How Traditional Authority is Involved	Responsible BYM Officer
Monthly Community Reports	Community Intelligence Officers share a summary of their Monthly Community Reports with the sub-chief of their community each month, before submission to the CIN Director. Chiefs are the first to know about issues in their communities.	CIN Officers + Director of Intelligence
Dispute Resolution	In the event of any dispute between community members and BYM representatives, or between communities, the relevant sub-chief is the first mediator. The BYM Home Secretary facilitates.	Home Secretary
Annual State of Community Report	Each year, the BYM DG presents the State of the Community Report to the Paramount Chief and Traditional Advisory Council at a formal durbar before public release.	DG + Secretary for Communications
Appointment of Interim Reps	Where no community representative is found, the sub-chief nominates an Interim Representative from their community on behalf of BYM (see Section 4.4).	Organiser + Home Secretary
Cultural Events & Festivals	BYM integrates its community development activities with existing traditional festivals (e.g., Ohum Festival). Chiefs are consulted on timing to avoid conflicts.	Organiser + Secretary for Communications
Youth Parliament	Sub-chiefs in each community are formally invited as Guests of Honour to each Youth Parliament sitting, reinforcing the legitimacy of the Parliament in the eyes of youth and families.	Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs
Accountability	The BYM DG presents a formal report to the Traditional Advisory Council at every six-month interval, and at the annual durbar, to account for the Assembly's progress, finances, and community impact.	DG + CFO

SDG Alignment

- ☐ SDG 16 (*Inclusive Institutions*)
- ☐ SDG 11 (*Sustainable Communities*)
- ☐ SDG 17 (*Partnerships*)



SECTION 4: COMMUNITY REPRESENTATION POLICY

4.1 Representation Structure

Every one of the 32 communities under the BYM Youth Assembly is entitled to three dedicated representatives, as follows:

- ☐ One (1) Youth Parliament Member, aged 10 - 17, Legislative representation
- ☐ One (1) Youth Development Council Representative, aged 18 - 45, Executive representation
- ☐ One (1) Community Intelligence Officer, aged 18+ , Intelligence and data representation

4.2 Official Residency Requirement

OFFICIAL RESIDENCY RULE - BYM POLICY

To represent a community in the BYM Youth General Assembly, a person must have been a genuine and continuous primary resident of that community for a MINIMUM of TWO (2) YEARS at the time of nomination, for Council and CIN roles. For Youth Parliament Members (ages 10 - 17), the minimum residency requirement is SIX (6) MONTHS, provided they currently attend a school serving that community.

Residency is defined as the community being the individual's primary place of residence, where they live, sleep, and are known to community members. Temporary or seasonal residence does not qualify [BUT THIS IS SUBJECT TO CHANGE](#)

Acceptable Proof of Residency

- ☐ A signed letter of endorsement from the community sub-chief, unit committee member, or elder
- ☐ Ghana National ID, Voter ID, or any official document showing community address
- ☐ School enrolment records (for Youth Parliament candidates, confirming attendance at a school serving the community)
- ☐ Testimony of two (2) recognised community members, submitted in writing to the Secretary-General - ***To be required documents soon !***

4.3 Strategic Selection Process

Step 1 - Formal Traditional Permission (Week 1)

Before any community engagement, the BYM DG and Civic Organiser pay a formal courtesy call on each sub-chief. A letter of introduction is presented and permission to operate within the community is formally sought and received.

Step 2 - Community Sensitisation (Weeks 2–4)

Following formal permission, BYM conducts community-level sensitisation through: schools, churches and mosques, market day announcements, community radio, and community meetings convened by the sub-chief.

Step 3 - Open Nomination Period (Weeks 5–6)

A two-week open nomination period is declared. Nominees may be self-nominated, nominated by community leaders, or nominated through schools. All nominations are submitted to the Secretary-General.



Step 4 - Vetting and Verification (Week 7)

All nominees are vetted by a panel comprising: the BYM DG, Secretary-General, Home Secretary, and one TAC member. Vetting covers: residency verification, character reference from a community leader, a 15-minute motivation interview, and confirmation of no criminal record or community misconduct.

Step 5 - Selection, Appointment & Community Announcement (Week 8)

Selected representatives are formally announced at a community meeting convened by the sub-chief. Each representative receives an official BYM Letter of Appointment signed by the President and Secretary-General.

4.4 Protocol for Communities Without a Representative

No Community Shall Be Left Without a Voice

If after two full nomination cycles a community produces no qualified candidate, the following three-tier Interim Representation Protocol is activated. At no point shall a community be permanently unrepresented. The BYM Organiser shall conduct a fresh recruitment drive every six months until a community-based resident is appointed.

☐ Tier 1 - Neighbouring Community Advocate

The nearest neighbouring community's Council Representative is designated as Interim Dual Representative for the unrepresented community. They must visit the community at least once monthly to collect CIN data and raise community issues at Council sittings. They receive additional recognition and BYM training priority.

☐ Tier 2 - BYM Caretaker Representative

If no neighbouring representative is available, the BYM **Home Secretary** appoints a Caretaker Representative, a trusted BYM volunteer who must visit the community at least twice monthly. This appointment lasts a maximum of six (6) months. Caretaker Representatives are not full voting members of the Council but may speak on behalf of the community.

☐ Tier 3 - Traditional Authority Liaison

If Tiers 1 and 2 are not feasible, BYM formally requests the sub-chief to designate a Traditional Liaison who will attend Assembly meetings and relay community concerns. This person is an observer, not a voting member, until a permanent community-based representative is found.



SECTION 5: HOW TO START THE YOUTH ASSEMBLY & YOUTH PARLIAMENT

5.1 Constituting the Youth General Assembly (Council)

1. Ratify this document at a BYM founding leadership meeting. All founding members sign below.
2. Present the document formally to the Paramount Chief for endorsement and Traditional Advisory Council formation or request official signatures of sub-chiefs to make officiate this document as an authentic supporting paper
3. Conduct the Sensitisation Tour across all 32 communities (with prior sub-chief permission obtained per Section 4.3, Step 1).
4. Collect nominations, conduct vetting, and issue Letters of Appointment to all Council Representatives and CIN Officers.
5. Hold the Inauguration Ceremony for the BYM Youth GAI. The DG administers the Oath of Service to all representatives, in the presence of the Paramount Chief or TAC representative.
6. Elect or appoint internal Council leadership: Council Chairperson, Deputy Chairperson, Council Secretary.
7. Conduct a 2-day Council Orientation Workshop covering: governance procedures, reporting tools, the Code of Conduct, and SDG alignment.
8. Hold the first official Council sitting within 21 days of inauguration.

5.2 Constituting the Bekwai Youth Parliament

9. The Secretary for Education & Youth visits all schools in Bekwai and sub-communities to introduce the Parliament and collect nominations from headmasters.
10. For communities without schools, nominations are collected at community meetings convened by the sub-chief.
11. All nominees undergo light vetting: a short interview with the Secretary for Education & Youth, and a character endorsement from a teacher or elder.
12. Parental or guardian consent forms are collected and filed for every Parliament Member before their first sitting.
13. A Parliamentary Orientation Day is held covering: Parliament's purpose, a Parliament Member's role, civic education basics, debate rules, and how to submit Youth Recommendations.
14. Parliament Members elect the Speaker and Deputy Speaker at the first sitting.
15. The first official sitting of the Bekwai Youth Parliament is held within 30 days of Orientation Day.
16. Parliament sits a minimum of three (3) times per year, aligned with school terms. Sittings are conducted in English and/or Twi.

Parliament Supervision Protocol

All Youth Parliament sittings must be supervised by the Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs and at least one Cabinet member. Sub-chiefs are formally invited as Guests of Honour to every sitting. A sub-chief or TAC member may be invited to give an opening blessing.



SECTION 6: DATABASE & RECORDS MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

The BYM Youth General Assembly operates a structured, multi-level records management system — the BYM Community Intelligence & Records Database (CIRD). This system ensures data-driven governance, transparent reporting, and long-term institutional memory. It is managed by the Director of Community Intelligence and overseen by the Secretary-General.

6.1 Database Architecture — The Five Registers

No	Register Name	What It Contains	Custodian	Reviewed
1	Member Register	Full name, date of birth, community, role/position, date of appointment, term dates, contact number, photo ID, residency verification status, training completed, SDG portfolio assignment.	Secretary-General	Monthly
2	Community Intelligence Register	Monthly Community Intelligence Reports from all 32 communities: issue category, severity rating, community affected, date reported, status (open/resolved/escalated), action taken, officer name.	Director of Intelligence	Monthly
3	Project & Volunteer Register	All BYM community projects: project name, community, Unit responsible, start/end dates, budget, volunteers involved, outcomes, SDG goal achieved, photos filed, status.	Relevant Unit Secretary	Quarterly
4	Financial Register	All income and expenditure: date, amount, source/payee, purpose, approved by, receipt reference, project code, bank balance. Signed off monthly by Treasurer and President.	CFO	Monthly
5	Traditional Authority & Partnership Register	Names and titles of all TAC members; dates of courtesy calls and meetings; signed MOUs and partnership agreements; NGO contacts; municipal authority contacts; diaspora network details.	Secretary for Regional Affairs	Quarterly

6.2 Digital & Physical Records System

Digital System

- ☐ Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Drive): Primary digital records storage, shared securely among Cabinet members
- ☐ Google Forms: Monthly CIN reporting forms, member registration, community issue submissions, volunteer sign-up
- ☐ WhatsApp Groups: Real-time communication by Unit, one group per Unit, managed by the relevant Secretary
- ☐ BYM Website: Public-facing register of published reports, open membership applications, and published minutes
- ☐ Excel/Google Sheets: Financial register, member register, and community intelligence tracking dashboards



Physical System

- ☐ A dedicated BYM Records Cabinet (lockable) held at the official BYM Secretariat
- ☐ Printed copies of all official signed documents, Letters of Appointment, and Constitution
- ☐ Physical Monthly Community Report binders, one per community, held by the Director of Intelligence
- ☐ Original signed financial documents, countersigned by Treasurer and President
- ☐ Photo ID cards for all Cabinet members and Representatives, issued by the Secretary-General

6.3 Data Privacy & Security Protocols

- ☐ All personal data is collected and stored in compliance with the Data Protection Act, 2012 (Ghana, Act 843)
- ☐ Personal data is accessible only to the Secretary-General, DG, and Director of Intelligence
- ☐ Community Intelligence data may be published in anonymised aggregate form only
- ☐ Financial records are subject to annual independent review
- ☐ The Data Quality Officer audits all CIN submissions monthly for accuracy

SDG Alignment

- ☐ *SDG 16 (Accountable & Transparent Institutions)*
- ☐ *SDG 17 (Data for Development)*



SECTION 7: SDG ALIGNMENT FRAMEWORK

The BYM Youth General Assembly formally aligns all its Units, programmes, and governance activities with the United Nations 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. This alignment ensures BYM's work is globally recognised, fundable by international and national development partners, and contributes to Ghana's national SDG reporting.

SDG Goal	Goal Title	BYM Unit Responsible	BYM Activities Aligned
SDG 1	No Poverty	Economic Empowerment Unit	Youth apprenticeship, microfinance linkages, income-generating skills training
SDG 3	Good Health & Well-being	Health & Social Welfare Unit	Community health campaigns, mental health awareness, substance abuse prevention
SDG 4	Quality Education	Education & Youth Dev. Unit	Literacy support, tutoring, Youth Parliament civic education, Youth Academy
SDG 5	Gender Equality	Secretary for Women & Equalities	40% female representation policy, women-led programmes, girl-child advocacy
SDG 6	Clean Water & Sanitation	Environment & Sanitation Unit	Community sanitation campaigns, hand-washing awareness, toilet facility advocacy
SDG 8	Decent Work & Economic Growth	Economic Empowerment Unit	Youth employment mapping, apprenticeship, entrepreneurship training
SDG 10	Reduced Inequalities	All Units	Inclusive representation across all 32 communities, minority community inclusion
SDG 11	Sustainable Communities	Environment Unit + Governance Unit	Community planning input, clean and safe environment campaigns
SDG 13	Climate Action	Environment & Sanitation Unit	Tree planting, climate education, community environmental brigades
SDG 15	Life on Land	Environment & Sanitation Unit	Tree planting, biodiversity awareness, anti-bush-burning campaigns
SDG 16	Peace, Justice & Institutions	Governance Unit + CIN	Non-political governance, transparent records, community dispute resolution
SDG 17	Partnerships for Goals	Secretary for Foreign Affairs	NGO partnerships, diaspora links, municipal collaboration, donor engagement

BYM SDG Reporting Commitment



BYM shall produce an annual SDG Progress Report, published alongside the State of the Community Report, measuring BYM's contribution to each of the 12 aligned SDGs. This report shall be submitted to the Municipal Assembly, shared with NGO partners, and published on the BYM website. It shall be presented to the Traditional Advisory Council at the annual durbar.



SECTION 8: STRATEGIC LAUNCH TIMELINE - 1 MAY 2026 TO 12 JANUARY 2027

This is the complete, binding operational roadmap for the BYM Youth General Assembly from initial ideation through to the Official Launch. All dates are operational targets and are to be treated as firm commitments by all Cabinet members and BYM Leadership.

PHASE 0: IDEATION & STRATEGIC PLANNING - MAY 2026

Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer / Status
BYM Leadership Retreat	1- 3 May 2026	Founding leadership meets to finalise the BYM Youth Assembly vision, mission, unit structure, governance model, and SDG alignment framework. This document was drafted and reviewed.	BYM DG - In Progress
Constitution Drafting	4 - 15 May 2026	Full Constitution drafted based on this governance document. Legal review conducted. All founding leadership members review and propose amendments.	Secretary-General
Traditional Authority Engagement Plan	16–20 May 2026	Formal engagement strategy designed for approaching the Paramount Chief and TAC. Courtesy call letters drafted. Protocol confirmed.	DG + ALLr
Branding & Identity Finalisation	21–31 May 2026	BYM Youth Assembly identity package finalised: official letterhead, stamp, email domain, social media handles, colour palette, and document templates. Website content planning begins.	Secretary for Communications

PHASE 1: FOUNDATION — JUNE 2026

Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer / Status
Constitution Ratification Ceremony	1–5 Jun 2026	Formal signing of the BYM Youth Assembly Constitution by all founding leadership. TAC formation letters issued to Paramount Chief and sub-chiefs.	DG + Secretary-General
Formal Courtesy Calls, Traditional Authority	6 - 20 Jun 2026	BYM DG and team visit Paramount Chief and all sub-chiefs in a structured tour. Formal presentation of BYM, seeking endorsement, and requesting permission to operate in each community. TAC formally constituted.	DG + Organisers
Cabinet Positions Advertised	15 - 30 Jun 2026	Cabinet positions (Civic Secretaries) opened for internal BYM application. Criteria published. Applications submitted to the Secretary-General.	Secretary-General + Home Secretary
Website Development Begins	15 Jun 2026	Domain registered, hosting activated, full BYM Youth Assembly website development begins based on approved design and content.	Secretary for Communications



PHASE 2: CABINET FORMATION & DIGITAL BUILD - JULY 2026

Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer
Civic Cabinet Vetting & Appointments	1 - 10 Jul 2026	All Cabinet Secretary applications vetted by DG, Secretary-General, Home Secretary, and TAC representative. Letters of Appointment issued to all 19 Cabinet members.	DG+ Home Secretary
Cabinet Inauguration Ceremony	12 Jul 2026	First Cabinet inducted into office at a formal ceremony. Oath of Service administered. TAC Patron invited to bless the occasion. Media coverage arranged.	DG + Secretary for Communications
Cabinet Orientation Workshop	13 - 14 Jul 2026	Two-day Cabinet orientation covering: the governance model, Civic Cabinet system adaptation, SDG frameworks, portfolio responsibilities, Code of Conduct, and reporting procedures.	Secretary-General
Database System Setup	15 - 25 Jul 2026	BYM CIRD database established: all five Registers created in Google Workspace. Access permissions assigned. Member Register populated with all Cabinet members.	Director of Intelligence + Secretary-General
Website Testing Phase	20 - 31 Jul 2026	Full BYM website built and internally tested: cross-browser, mobile, forms, content accuracy, SDG alignment section, leadership page. Errors corrected.	Secretary for Communications

PHASE 3: COMMUNITY RECRUITMENT - AUGUST 2026

Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer
Community Sensitisation Tour	1 - 20 Aug 2026	BYM Cabinet visits all 32 communities with sub-chief's formal permission. Sensitisation materials: flyers, radio broadcasts, church/mosque announcements, community meetings. All three roles explained.	Organiser + relevant Secretaries
Nominations Open	21 - 31 Aug 2026	Open nomination period for: Council Representatives (18 - 45), Youth Parliament Members (10 - 17), and CIN Officers. Physical forms at community centres + Google Forms online. Sub-chiefs formally notified.	Secretary-General + Organiser

PHASE 4: VETTING, APPOINTMENT & TRAINING - SEPTEMBER 2026

Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer
Nominee Vetting	1 - 14 Sept 2026	All nominees vetted by the Vetting Panel (DG, Secretary-General, Home Secretary, TAC member). Residency confirmed. Character references collected. Motivation interviews conducted. Database updated.	DG + Home Secretary
Letters of Appointment Issued	15 - 20 Sept 2026	All selected representatives formally appointed. Letters of Appointment issued and signed.	Secretary-General + Organiser



Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer
		Community announcements made in presence of sub-chief.	
Council Representatives Orientation	22 - 23 Sept 2026	Two-day orientation for all 32 Council Representatives: governance procedures, community reporting tools, SDG alignment, Code of Conduct, database system, and Oath of Service.	Secretary-General + DG
CIN Officers Training	24 - 25 Sept 2026	Two-day training for all 32 CIN Officers: data collection methods, Monthly Community Report format, Google Forms submission, urgent issue flagging protocols, database entry standards.	Director of Intelligence
BYM Website Final Approval	26 - 30 Sept 2026	Website reviewed by DG and all members. Final corrections made. Website approved and set to 'coming soon' with countdown to pre-launch.	Secretary for Communications

PHASE 5: PARLIAMENT & VOLUNTEER TEAM FORMATION - OCTOBER 2026

Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer
School Outreach, Youth Parliament	1 - 14 Oct 2026	The Secretary for Education visits all schools in Bekwai and sub-communities to introduce the Youth Parliament, collect nominations, and distribute parent consent forms.	Secretary for Education
Youth Parliament Orientation Day	20 Oct 2026	Full-day orientation for all 32 Parliament nominees. Topics: Parliament purpose, roles, debate rules, civic education, Youth Recommendations. Parental consent forms collected. Speaker and Deputy Speaker elected.	Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs
First Youth Parliament Sitting (Practice)	25 Oct 2026	First practice sitting of the Bekwai Youth Parliament. Sub-chiefs invited as Guests of Honour. One practice community issue debated and a Youth Recommendation produced.	Speaker + Secretary for Youth Parliament Affairs
Volunteer Action Teams Constituted	Oct 2026	Six Volunteer Action Teams formed: Sanitation, Education, Health, Employment, Environment, Social Welfare. Team Leads appointed. Brief orientation conducted.	Organiser + relevant Secretaries

PHASE 6: SYSTEM ACTIVATION & PRE-LAUNCH PREPARATION, NOVEMBER - DECEMBER 2026

Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer
BYM Website Goes LIVE	1 Nov 2026	BYM Youth Assembly website publicly launched. Social media accounts activated. Online member registration form live. Countdown to Official Launch begins.	Secretary for Communications
First CIN Data Collection Cycle	1 - 30 Nov 2026	All 32 CIN Officers conduct the first official Community Baseline Report. Data submitted via Google Forms. Director of Intelligence compiles the first aggregate community report.	Director of Intelligence



Activity	Date	Details	Lead Officer
First Official Cabinet Meeting	5 Nov 2026	First formal monthly CC meeting held. Minutes recorded. SDG progress tracking begins.	DG + Secretary-General
First Council Sitting (Internal)	15 Nov 2026	First internal sitting of the GA, reviewing community data, setting initial project priorities, agreeing first volunteer action plans.	1st DDG
Pre-Launch Logistics Confirmed	1 - 15 Dec 2026	Venue booked, programme finalised, guest list confirmed (including Paramount Chief and all sub-chiefs), media invited, catering arranged, cultural groups confirmed, banners/branding produced.	Organiser + Secretary for Communications
Final Systems Check	16 - 23 Dec 2026	All five database registers are verified. Website content updated. ID cards printed for all members. Pre-launch ceremony rehearsed. First SDG Baseline Report prepared.	Secretary-General + Director of Intelligence

PRE-LAUNCH CEREMONY - 24 DECEMBER 2026

Pre-Launch Event - 24th December 2026

The BYM Youth General Assembly Pre-Launch Ceremony marks the formal public introduction of the Assembly, its Cabinet, Council Representatives, Parliament Members, and CIN Officers to Sefwi Bekwai and all 31 sub-communities. The Paramount Chief and all sub-chiefs are formally invited.

Item	Time	Programme Details	Responsibility
Arrival & Registration	9:00 AM	Venue opens. Guest registration, cultural display, seating of traditional authority with full protocol.	Organiser
Opening	10:00 AM	Welcome address by BYM DG. Introduction of full CC, Council Representatives, Parliament Members, and CIN Officers.	DG
Constitution Ceremony	10:30 AM	Public reading of the BYM Youth Assembly Mission and Vision. Constitution displayed. Letters of Appointment presented to all representatives before the Paramount Chief.	Secretary-General
TAC Address	11:00 AM	Formal address by the Paramount Chief (or TAC Patron). Blessing of the Assembly.	TAC Patron
Parliament Demonstration	11:30 AM	Symbolic first public Parliament sitting. One community issue debated. Youth Recommendation presented to Cabinet.	Speaker + DG
Vote of Thanks & Celebration	12:00 PM	Vote of thanks. Community celebration. Media interviews. Photography. Social media live coverage.	Secretary for Communications
Leadership Debrief	2:30 PM	Cabinet debrief meeting. Lessons noted. Adjustments for Official Launch confirmed.	President + Secretary-General

**BRIDGE PERIOD - 25 DECEMBER 2026 TO 11 JANUARY 2027**

Activity	Date	Details	Lead
Holiday Rest	25 - 28 Dec 2026	Statutory rest period. BYM leadership available for emergency queries only.	All CC
Debrief Actions Implemented	29 - 31 Dec 2026	All action items from Pre-Launch debrief addressed. Outstanding community gaps filled. Database updated.	Secretary-General
First Council Meeting of 2027	2 Jan 2027	First official Council meeting of 2027. Community baseline data reviewed. Agenda for Official Launch Council sitting set. First SDG Baseline Report finalised.	1st DDG + DG
Final Launch Logistics	3 - 11 Jan 2027	Official Launch venue confirmed, programme finalised, guest invitations sent to all dignitaries. Social media campaigns intensified. Countdown posts daily. Banners and programmes printed.	Organiser + Secretary for Communications

OFFICIAL LAUNCH - 12 JANUARY 2027**OFFICIAL LAUNCH - 12th January 2027 | FOUNDING DAY OF THE BYM YOUTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY**

The Official Launch is the founding public ceremony of the BYM Youth General Assembly. It will mark the day the Assembly is formally declared open, in full operation, and accountable to the communities of Sefwi Bekwai and its 31 sub-communities. All traditional leaders, municipal authorities, school heads, and media are formally invited.

Item	Time	Programme Details	Responsibility
Arrival	8:30 AM	Venue open. Guest registration. Cultural display. Traditional authority seated with full protocol.	Organiser
Processional Entry	9:30 AM	Processional entry of BYM CC, Council Representatives, and Parliament Members. National Anthem and BYM Pledge.	Secretary-General
Welcome Address	10:00 AM	Welcome to BYM DG. Overview of the Assembly, its structure, SDG alignment, and commitment to all 32 communities.	DG
Traditional Address	10:20 AM	Address by Paramount Chief / TAC Patron. Blessing of the Assembly and charge to all representatives.	TAC Patron
Municipal Authority Address	10:40 AM	Address by Municipal Chief Executive or District Director of Education.	Guest Dignitary
Launch Declaration	11:00 AM	The BYM President formally declares the BYM Youth General Assembly open and in full operation. The BYM flag is raised. SDG banner displayed.	DG
First Official Council Sitting	11:30 AM	First full public sitting of the Youth Development Council. One community resolution passed and signed. Sub-chiefs witness.	1st DDG + Council Chair



Item	Time	Programme Details	Responsibility
Parliament Inaugural Sitting	12:15 PM	First full official sitting of the Bekwai Youth Parliament, presided over by the Speaker. Sub-chiefs as Guests of Honour.	Speaker
SDG Commitment Declaration	1:00 PM	BYM President reads the BYM SDG Commitment Declaration, formal pledge to contribute to the 12 aligned SDGs.	DG
Community Celebration & Exhibition	1:15 PM	Community lunch and fellowship. Exhibition stands for each Unit and Volunteer Action Team showing planned projects.	Organiser
Press Conference	2:30 PM	BYM DG and Secretary-General take questions from media representatives.	Secretary for Communications
Official Close	3:30 PM	Vote of thanks. Group photographs. Social media live coverage throughout.	Secretary-General
Post-Launch Cabinet Debrief	5:00 PM	Full Civic Cabinet debrief. First action items assigned. First Monthly Community Reports confirmed for February 2027.	DG



SECTION 9: CODE OF CONDUCT & CORE PRINCIPLES

9.1 Non-Political Principle

The BYM Youth General Assembly is strictly non-political and non-partisan. No member shall use their BYM position to campaign for, endorse, or advance any political party or candidate. Violation shall result in immediate suspension pending investigation and possible removal.

9.2 Service Over Self

All members serve the community, not themselves. No representative shall use their position for personal financial gain, corrupt conduct, or the advancement of personal interests above the community interest.

9.3 Inclusion and Equality

At least 40% of all positions across the Assembly shall be held by women. No community, regardless of size or distance from Bekwai town, shall be treated as less important than another.

9.4 Accountability and Transparency

All financial transactions, community reports, and project outcomes shall be published in the quarterly State of the Community Report and the annual SDG Progress Report, available to all community members and stakeholders.

9.5 Alignment With Traditional Authority

All BYM activities respect the authority of traditional leaders. BYM shall never act in any community without first seeking and receiving the blessing and permission of the relevant sub-chief or traditional authority.

9.6 Term Limits

Position	Term Length	Max Terms	Renewable?
DG of the Youth General Assembly	2 years	2	Yes - once only
DDG (1st and 2nd)	2 years	2	Yes - once only
Civic Cabinet Secretaries	2 years	3	Yes, subject to performance review
Secretary-General	2 years	Unlimited	Yes
CFO	2 years	2	Yes - once only
Council Representatives	3 years	2	Yes - once only
Youth Parliament Members	2 years	2	Yes, until age limit of 17
Community Intelligence Officers	1 year, renewable	No limit	Reviewed annually



SECTION 10: RATIFICATION & OFFICIAL SIGNATURES

This document is the founding governance framework of the BYM Youth General Assembly. It shall take effect upon signature by the BYM founding leadership. It shall be reviewed annually, with proposed amendments submitted in writing to the Secretary-General no less than 14 days before the annual review meeting, and approved by a two-thirds majority of the Cabinet.

Annual Review Commitment

This document shall be formally reviewed at the first Civic Cabinet meeting of each new year. All revisions shall be recorded in the Document Amendment Register held by the Secretary-General. A revised version shall be presented to the Traditional Advisory Council at the annual durbar.

Ratified at Sefwi Bekwai, Western North Region, Ghana

Date: _____ **2026**

DG, BYM Youth General Assembly

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Secretary-General, BYM Youth Assembly

Name: _____

Signature: _____

1st DDG

Name: _____

Signature: _____

CFO

Name: _____

Signature: _____

TAC Patron — Paramount Chief

(or designated representative)

Name / Title: _____

Stamp / Signature: _____

Home Secretary

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Official BYM Stamp: _____



BYM YOUTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY | VOLUNTEERING FOR CHANGE

Sefwi Bekwai | Western North Region | Ghana | Est. 2026

Aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) 2030